

Jacob Ugalde

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SYMBYAI

Front End Engineer

Remote, USA

2025 - Present

Built and scaled the core web application for an AI-driven SaaS startup aiming to streamline the peer review process and academic publishing pipeline. Converted pitch abstractions into tangible designs and code, with accessibility, responsiveness, security, and ease of experience as guiding principles. \$800k in pre-launch ARR, with 800+ signed on the waitlist.

- Developed pages primarily with TypeScript, React, SCSS, Next.js, and Node.js, creating a scalable component library to allow new features to be built on top of existing infrastructure with minimal refactoring
- Integrated Stripe for subscription payment handling, Mixpanel for user analytics, and other third-party services
- Designed data flows and API endpoints for project tracking, file upload actions, AI paper analysis, organization management, user authentication, database querying, and more
- Produced marketing assets and visual libraries in the form of demo videos, slide decks, icons, and data visualizers
- Utilized enterprise-level Claude Code to assist in PR reviews, feature development, backlog refinement, and more, but importantly using my own experience and expertise to catch hallucinations and filter out noise

MADISON SQUARE GARDEN SPHERE ENTERTAINMENT CO.

Software Engineer

Burbank, CA

2022 - 2023

Developed audiovisual content and pipelines for the Las Vegas Sphere venue that premiered with its debut in the Summer of 2023, with initial daily impressions reaching an estimated 300,00 in-person and 4 million via social media.

- Optimized content development pipelines by creating interactive tools and templates for over 100 prospective brands and artists to efficiently display their content, reducing production time from 3-4 months to 2 weeks on average, and contributing towards a first-year revenue to \$346M
- Spearheaded initiatives for QA testing and API documentation to ensure product consistency and accuracy

IDOBI NETWORK

Web Developer

North Hollywood, CA

2021 - 2022

One of 2 programmers developing the primary website for a large-scale internet radio station with over 3M unique monthly visitors. Led development on a complete overhaul of the site's design, implementing cookies and other features that created additional ad space and points for monetization, increasing monthly listeners by 23% and revenue by 45%.

- Recreated WordPress plugins from scratch via JavaScript, HTML, PHP, and React, saving on long-term costs and maintenance by over \$84,000 annually
- Drove development on persistent radio players built into the website's header, allowing listeners to not only browse while listening, but also providing more opportunities for auditory ad space

GENERAL ATOMICS

Software Developer

San Diego, CA

2018 - 2019

Led full-stack development efforts on B2B embedded software for data visualization, databases, and early AI prototypes.

- Deployed a web application via Docker, Kubernetes, and PostgreSQL to compare custom AI prediction models to human prediction, showcasing a 40% reduction in fatal machinery errors and saving \$340,000 annually in repair cost
- Developed company-wide live database visualizers with easy-to-understand sorting and filtering functionality
- Represented General Atomics at remote stakeholder presentations, helping garner multiple 6-figure contracts

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

Major in Interdisciplinary Computing and the Arts, Minor in Computer Science

La Jolla, CA

- Graduated with Bachelor of Arts Degree, GPA: 3.57

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Programming Languages: TypeScript, React, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS, PHP, WordPress, SQL, Java
- Skills: Git, Bitbucket, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Notion, Adobe Creative Suite, MS Visual Studio, Agile Development